Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
January 14, 2026

ATTENDEES
(V = voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal
Andi Gourlay - Vice-Principal
Bibi Corbeil - teacher rep
Cherain Serrador - Chair
Vasco Serrador (V)
Chantelle Tinnes (V)
Zac Jones (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V)
Shannon Wall (V)
Christine Dalsto (V)
Yvonne Branski (V)
Vina Danger (V)
Amy Ellison (V)
Cindy Ma (V)
Stephanie MacLachlan (V)
Ashley Church (V)
Dipesh Patel (V)
Rene Corbeil (V)
Rebecca Goodard
Natalie Nowak

Regrets

Kim Fowler - community rep
Selena Mather (V)

Meeting Minutes

1. **Welcome**
   - Mr Wilson shared the territorial acknowledgment that they do everyday in school and also in staff meetings to support reconciliation
   - Mr Wilson shared two First Nations artworks that are about community and connection to emphasis school as a community
   - New school council attendee Natalie Nowack who has 3 kids introduced herself

2. **Principals Update**
   - School Sign
     - No movement
   - Parking
     - Parking Lot Attendant has quit and the school is looking for a new Attendant. In the meantime, Mr Wilson and Ms Gourlay have been performing the job and have changed the traffic flow to help increase and manage safety

    - The school continues to work with the Student Transportation Services of Waterloo Region (STSWR)
    - Issues include teachers being forced to park on the street due to no parking available in the parking lot and vehicles running with no occupants
    - Question whether Bylaw ticketing has helped the parking situation? Yes and No
    - Question whether Bylaw will ticket cars parked on the street during a snow event? Unsure
    - The Chair has been in continued contact with Cambridge City about the parking lot situation
- Snow Clearing and Tarmac Maintenance
    - Provincial salt shortage has resulted in school entrances being closed and kids kept inside in some instances
    - This is an ongoing issue that many schools are facing, and that the WRDSB is dealing with
    - The milder weather has helped considerably to melt the ice
- PD Day Friday 16th
- Report cards will be sent home Feb 9th.
- Olympics Spirit Event planned to be run around Feb 6th
- Carnaval
    - Thursday Feb 12th
    - Run by the French Department and mimics the Carnaval de Quebec
    - Kids play games outside
    - No hot chocolate this year. School will be providing maple candies
    - Volunteers needed to help with setup in the morning e.g. as soon as the bell rings

3. Budget Summary

- Ended at $53.5k
- Cash of $48.5k and bingo $5k
- Slow month with only expense being pizza
- Mr Wilson has gone back through the budget and currently $50k has been allocated leaving only $3.2k unallocated
- Discussion about whether any allocations need to be re-evaluated
- Grade 7 & 8 end of year trip - deposits are already being received
- Scientist in Schools - 8 classes have already requested access. Hopefully all G 1-6 classes will have the opportunity to use it

4. Bingo Update

- Working on a sharable excel spreadsheet for shift signup
- Many thanks to Bibi and Nisha for signing up for so many shifts
- When volunteers are unavailable, C and/or V Serrador take the shift
- If each person signed up for one shift a year it would help
- Still need volunteers for following shifts:
    - Sun May 2nd 8-10pm
    - Sun May 17th 8-10pm

    - Sun Nov 1st 8-10pm
    - Sun Dec 27th 8-10pm

- School has received a request that the Bingo application be more explicit as to what the bingo funds are being used for. Suggestion to use bingo funds to cover approx $11-12k of previously approved items from budget e.g. musical instruments, student club support

5. WRAPSC Update

- Ongoing consultation to discuss whether to keep, amend or scrap current Strategic Plan
- Consensus was that the Strategic Plan was good except there are no metrics to measure achievement and no detail as to how the plan would be achieved
- WRDSB is the first school board to track classroom evacuations. The first report will be released Jan 19
- Current ETFO collective agreement ends Aug 2026. Union is expecting a hard negotiation and asks for support in getting the provincial government to invest in education
- PIC - largest engagement so far with the entire $16k budget allocated
- Public Education Advocacy Symposium will be on Feb 21 1-3pm. Attended by WRDSB, WRCDSB, PIC, ETFO, and hopefully MPPs and Trustees. Attendance limited to school council chairs for now

6. Upcoming Events

Family Games Night

- Applied for and received PRO Grant of $750 for family games night
- Grant will be used for a free family game night on Feb 11th or 18th
- Food will not be provided or allowed as it will be held in the library
- Volunteers will be required for setup/takedown, as well as to possibly help during the event
- 40 decks of cards were also purchased and will be sent home with families who attend with instructions for games
- After the event, teachers will be able to sign out the games for use in the classroom, during indoor recess etc
- Budgeted amount of $2K might not be required as the PRO Grant may cover all costs
- AGREED date of Feb 18th, 6-8pm
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Booster Juice

- To be held Feb 27th
- Chair will send out a request for volunteers

Family Movie Night

- Free event, Mar 27th or Apr 24th. Approx 6:30 to 9pm
- Movie has not yet been picked

- Historically it has been a paid event and people were allowed to bring in any food/drinks they want. This time it will be a free event so as to build community and free popcorn/water will be provided
- No outside food/drink will be allowed due to allergies and litter
- Because of issues some kids may have with popcorn, alternative options will also be provided e.g. fruit pouches
- AGREED date of Mar 27th

Scholastic Book Fair

- No plans to hold a book fair this year
- Readathon was successful last year, suggestion that it be held again this year
- Mr Wilson supported the idea of a Readathon this year. Date in April to be confirmed.

Social Media

- The Chair will send details of events to the communication officer R. Chamberlain who will create posters/notices. These will then be distributed to other board members to place around school, provide to students etc.

End Of Year Celebration

- Discussion about whether to have an End of Year Celebration this year
- Previous years have been well attended but have required huge efforts with insufficient volunteer support
- If the event is to be held, a dedicated Committee would be required. Possibility of scaling down the event to ensure easier organisation.
- Sufficient volunteers would be needed for setup, takedown and during the event including coordinating directly with vendors etc.
- Suggestion to buy outdoor extension cords for use at the event
- Its understand there would be community backlash if event doesn't run
- Event ideas - free raffle, book sale, and cake sale
- Possible June 10th date
- Difficult to have the event inside in inclement weather as it would affect the custodial staff and require further cleaning
- Decision on whether or not to have this event held over until the next council meeting

7. Meeting close

- Next meeting Wednesday Feb 11th
- Suggestion to have the option to meet in person for all council meetings. Mr. Wilson agreed that a few times a year would be ideal but not every meeting due to the other commitments of council members